

Life on the ice

Life is tough by the oceans in the North and South poles. The freezing conditions mean that many animals struggle to survive. While some travel to warmer places to escape the cold, those left behind must adapt to the temperature and lack of food.

FACT FILE

- » **Length:** Up to 10 ft (3 m)
- » **Weight:** Up to 1,320 lb (600 kg)
- » **Swim speed:** Up to 24 mph (39 kph)
- » **Ocean:** Southern

Leopard seal

A double layer of fat keeps seals warm. The leopard seal's smooth body shape is suited to fast swimming, while its powerful jaws are used to catch prey.

» Scale



FACT FILE

- » **Height:** Up to 2.5 ft (0.8 m)
- » **Weight:** Up to 12 lb (5.4 kg)
- » **Swim speed:** Up to 22 mph (36 kph)
- » **Ocean:** Southern

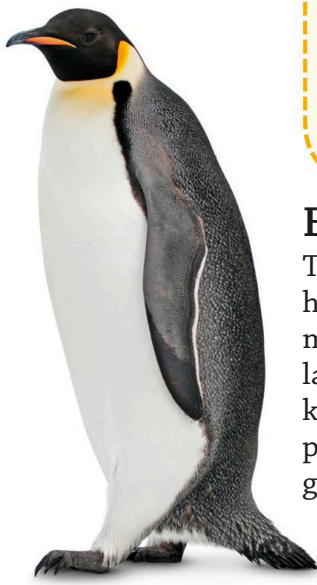
» Scale



Gentoo penguin

To stay warm and active, penguins have thick skin and layers of fat, called blubber. With their winglike flippers, they can swim at high speeds to catch fish.

» Scale



Emperor penguin

This, the tallest and heaviest penguin, has many feathers and layers of fat to help keep it warm. Emperor penguins also huddle in groups to stay warm.

FACT FILE

- » **Height:** Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
- » **Weight:** Up to 88 lb (40 kg)
- » **Swim speed:** Up to 8 mph (12 kph)
- » **Ocean:** Southern